ANSWER TO YOUR QUESTION · NOTHING IS BUILT YET · THE PLAN DOES NOT CHANGE UNTIL YOU PICK

Can it be a lifesaver?

A raw answer, three tools that save writers money and worry, and how they reach tons of people

Date	2026-10-16
Prepared for	Pipe199x
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Your question	"I want people to say 'Man, whoever made this is a lifesaver!', using A/B testing. I see it a bit boring. How do we become a lifesaver for tons of people?"
Try it	The clickable prototype: `docs/plan/answers/LIFESAVER.html` (offline), and a private claude.ai page (link in the chat). EN/ES button at the top.

The short answer

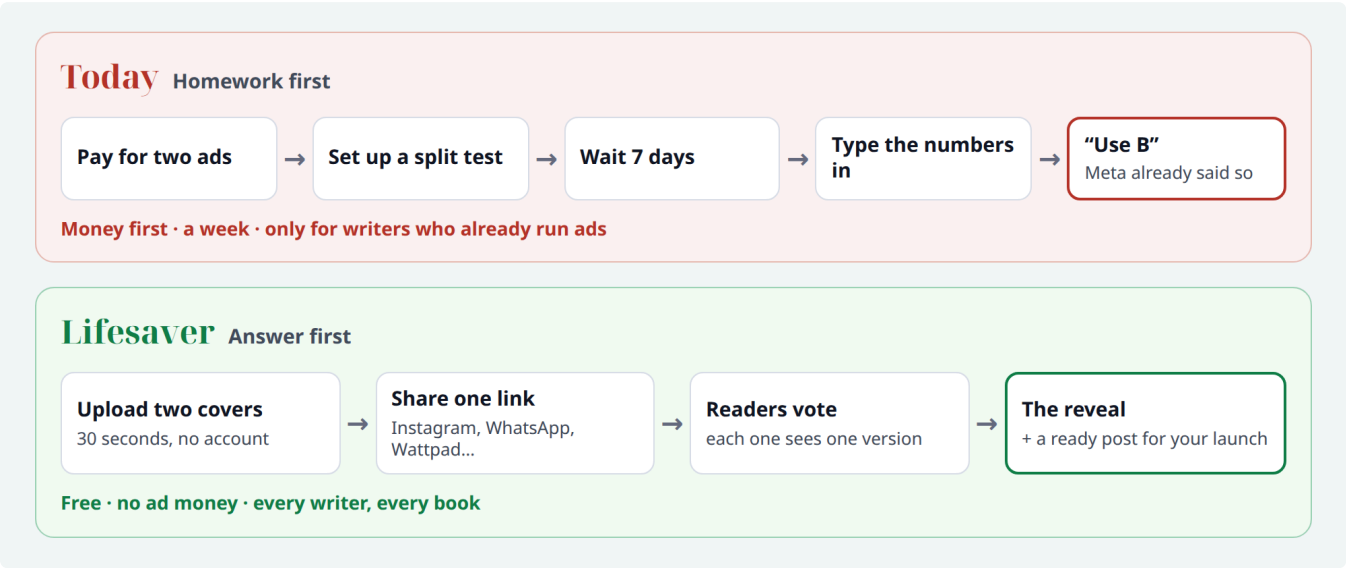
Today	**No, it's not a lifesaver yet.** It's a good calculator that comes with homework: pay for ads, wait a week, type numbers, then get an answer Meta already gave you.
The fix	**A/B testing becomes the engine, never the product.** We start from a pain the writer feels today, and the test runs underneath.
Three tools	**Duel:** a free cover test with real readers. **Ad Doctor:** what to stop paying for in your ads. **Real or luck?:** the truth about a sales change, in 5 seconds.
Tons of people	Every Duel link brings readers, some of them are writers, and every result fills the library by itself. The same Duel can later serve anyone choosing between two images.
What I need	Try the prototype. Show it to 5 writers. Then pick from **L1–L11** on the last page.

a pain you feel today + an answer in minutes + free, no sign-up + you see what you saved + you tell a friend = **a lifesaver**

Your Word-to-PDF example has all five. Today's tool has only the third.

1 Why it feels boring today

The tool gives its answer at the end of a week of work and money. A lifesaver gives it in the first minute.



#	Why it feels boring	What it means
1	**It only helps writers who already run A/B tests in ads.**	Most writers don't. The ones who do already get the winner from Meta or TikTok.
2	**It asks for something before it gives anything.**	Money for two ads, a week of waiting, typing numbers. Then one line.
3	**The library is empty on day one.**	It fills only if writers do extra, unpaid work after their test.
4	**It speaks our language.**	We say "tests, clicks, p-value". Writers think "Which cover? Why don't I sell? Where does my money go?"
5	**Nothing to show a friend.**	No "look what this told me" moment, so nobody spreads it.

New rule. A/B testing is the engine, never the product. Nobody wants "an A/B test". People want "the right cover", "my money back" and "the truth".

Stop doing:

- opening with the library (empty on day one);
- opening with "Plan an ad test" (homework);
- statistics words on the first screen.

2 Three painful moments, three lifesavers

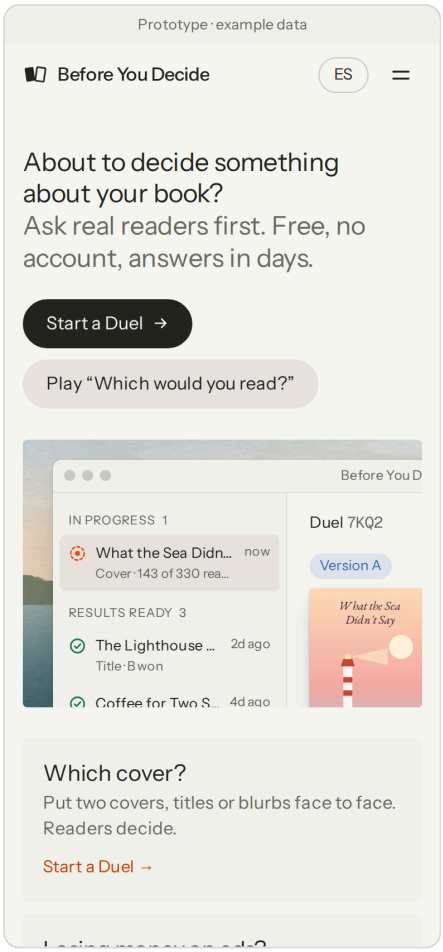
The moment	What writers do today	The lifesaver
"Which cover?" (or title, blurb, book idea)	Ask friends or post a poll: people see both covers and the votes, and most are friends. Or pay PickFu: about $1 per answer, about $50 for 50 people.	**Duelo · Duel**: a free, real A/B test with readers. Results in days.
"My ads eat my money"	Guess when to stop a keyword. Advice goes from "2–3 clicks" to "30+ clicks".	**Doctor de anuncios · Ad Doctor**: drop the report, see what to stop. 10 seconds.
"I changed something and sales went up. Did it work?"	Believe it.	**¿Real o suerte? · Real or luck?**: two numbers, the truth in 5 seconds.

A new home page with three doors. Each door is a pain, in the writer's words. No forms, no statistics words. The library and the ad-test planner move inside.

A warmer voice everywhere: plain, kind, direct. For example: "Too close to call. Both work. Pick the one you love and stop worrying."

Where the A/B testing is, in each one:

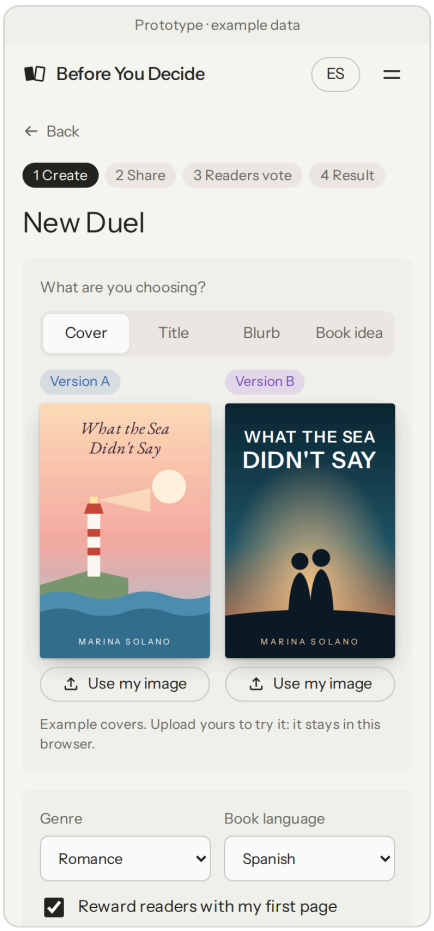
- **Duel: a real A/B test with real people.** Random assignment, one version per person, a fixed number of readers, a split check (SRM). The "Which would you read?" game sends more readers into the same Duels.
- **Ad Doctor: A/B-test math, not an experiment.** Each keyword is compared with the book's own average. Amazon decides who sees each keyword, so it shows what loses money, not why.
- **Real or luck?: the same math on a before/after count.** Not an experiment either, so for a sure answer about a cover or a title it points to a Duel.



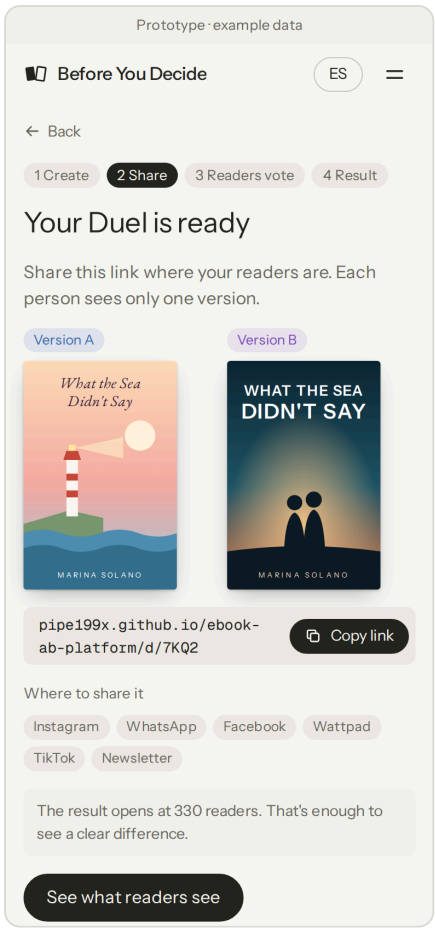
The new home page (prototype, phone).

3 The Duel: real A/B testing, free

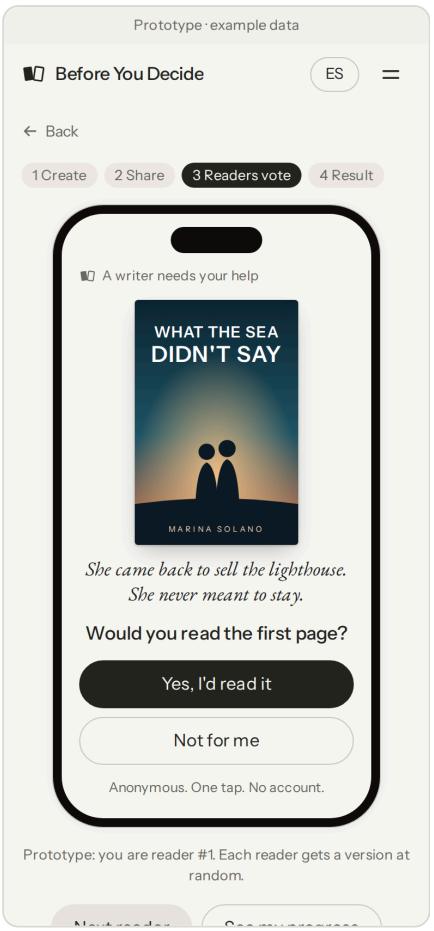
> Two covers face each other. Each reader sees only one, picked at random, like a book in a store. Readers decide, not friends.



1 · Upload two covers, or two titles, blurbs or book ideas. 30 seconds, no account.



2 · One link to share on Instagram, WhatsApp, Wattpad, TikTok or a newsletter.



3 · A reader sees one version and taps once: "Would you read the first page?"

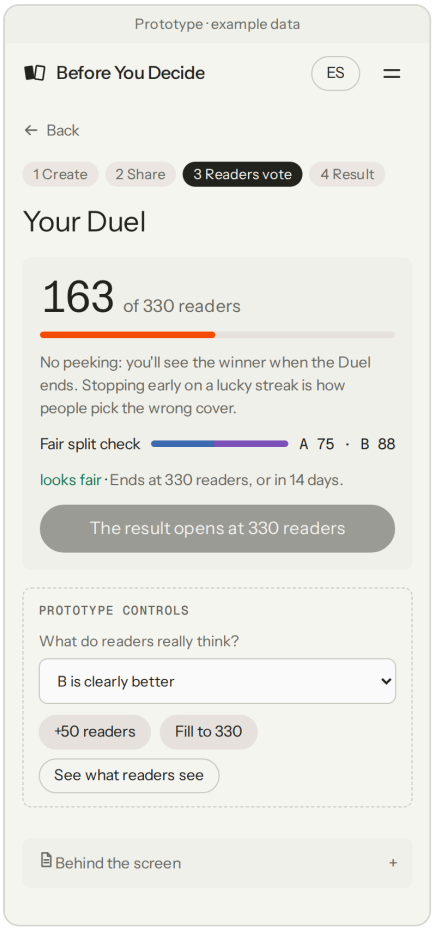
Why this is honest (and a poll is not):

- one version per person, at random: nobody compares side by side;
- nobody sees the votes, so nobody follows the crowd;
- the writer's own phone doesn't count, and each visitor votes once;
- the number of readers is fixed before it starts;
- a split check (SRM) catches bugs and abuse.

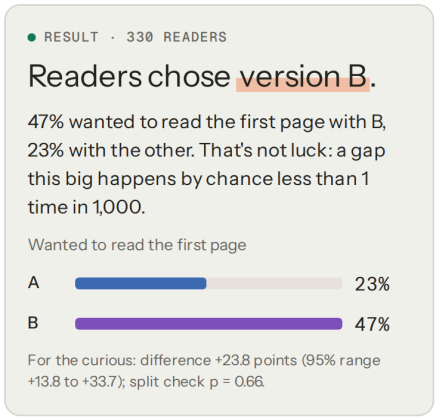
Bonus for the writer: voters who said yes can read the first page and follow the writer's own "tell me when it's out" link. The Duel picks the cover **and** finds the first readers.

Bonus for the launch: "Help me choose my cover!" is a post followers love. The Duel turns a decision into launch buzz.

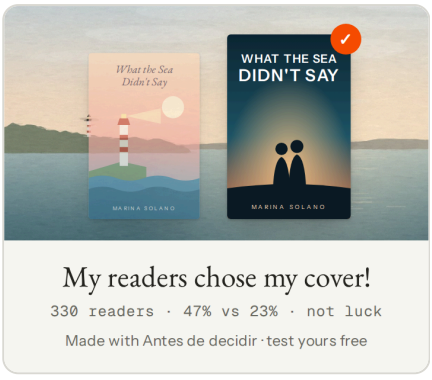
4 The Duel: the honest result



4 · Progress, not the winner. No peeking means no fake winners from a lucky streak.

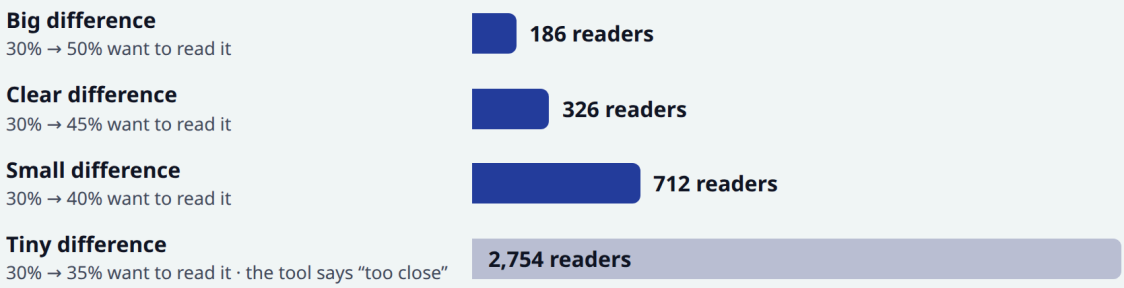


5 · The reveal, in plain words, with the numbers for the curious (prototype, example votes).



6 · A ready post: "My readers chose my cover!" Every viewer sees "test yours free".

How many readers a Duel needs

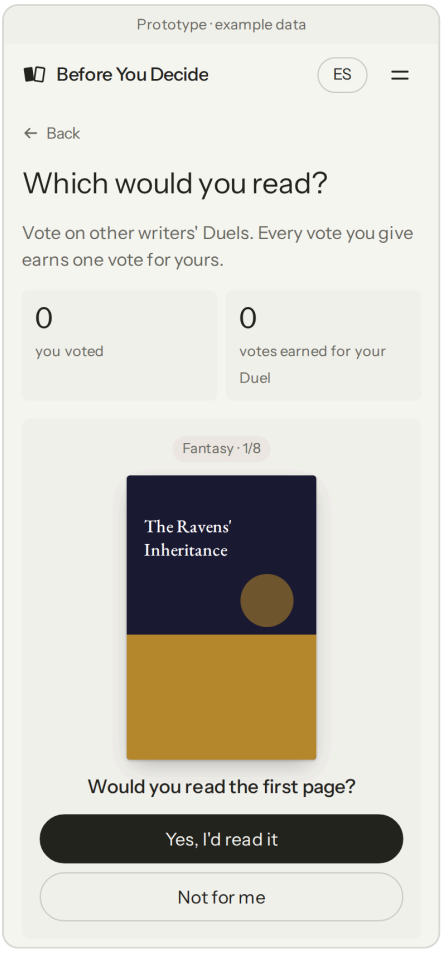


Two-sided 95% test, 80% power, half the readers see each version; the same formula as the rest of the plan (abstats.js). The prototype's Duel opens at 330 readers: the clear difference, rounded up.

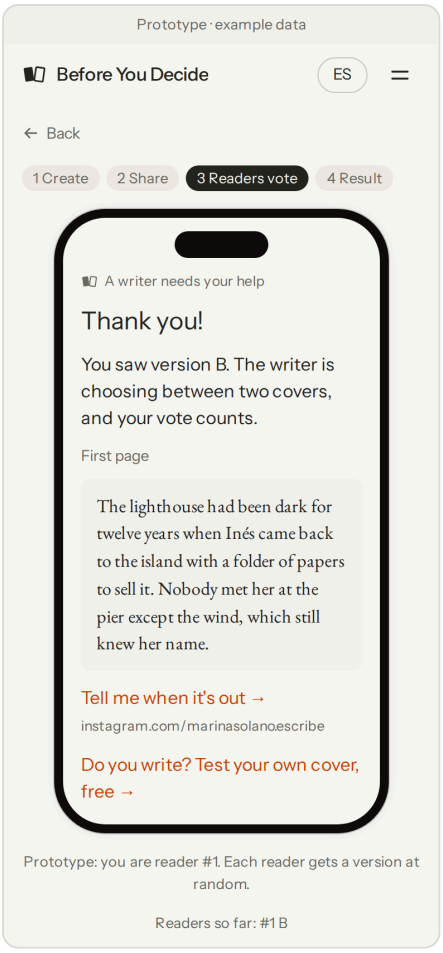
Four honest endings, never a guess: "Readers chose B" (not luck) · "Too close to call: both work" (also an answer) · "Not sure yet: about N more readers" · "Not fair yet" (the random split broke, so no winner). The prototype shows all four.

5 No followers? Vote to earn votes

"¿Cuál leerías? · Which would you read?" is a 2-minute game. Every vote a writer gives on other writers' Duels earns one vote for their own. Photofeeler uses this same "karma" model for profile photos.



The game: one cover, one tap, a counter of votes earned.



What a voter gets after voting: the first page, the writer's link, and "test yours free".

Why people play: judging covers is fun, takes seconds, and readers discover new books. Writers play because it fills their own Duel.

The cost: people upload images, so someone checks them. At first, you approve which Duels enter the game. Links stay unlisted, there is a report button, and covers are deleted 30 days after the Duel.

6 Ad Doctor: stop paying for what doesn't sell

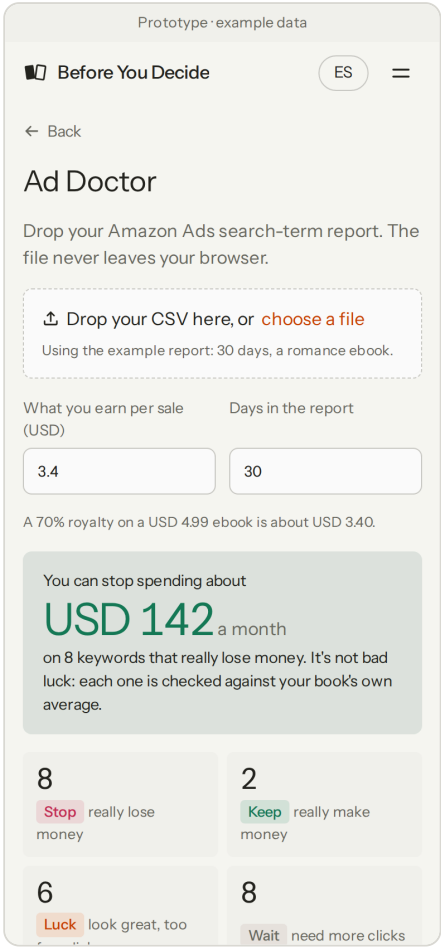
> The writer drops in the Amazon Ads search-term report. In seconds, in plain words: what to stop, what to keep, what is luck, and how long to wait. **The file never leaves the browser.**

Verdict	In the example	Rule (in plain words)
Stop	8 · USD 142 a month	At least 10 clicks, and 90% sure it earns less than it costs.
Keep	2	At least 10 clicks, and 90% sure it earns more than it costs.
Luck	6	Looks great, but from fewer than 15 clicks. Don't raise the bid yet.
Wait	8	Wait about N more clicks. If it's too close to break-even to judge soon, pause it when money is tight.

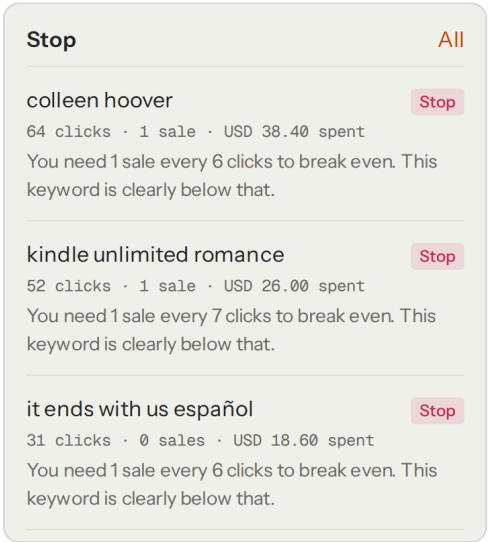
How it decides. Each keyword starts from the book's own average, as if it already had 20 clicks; then its own clicks and sales move it (a beta-binomial model). Break-even = cost per click ÷ what the writer earns per sale (70% of a USD 4.99 ebook is about USD 3.40).

Why writers need it. Advice on when to pause a keyword goes from "2–3 clicks" to "30+ clicks". The right number depends on the book. The Doctor computes it.

Meta Ads: book ads there usually send people to Amazon, so Meta sees clicks, not sales. The full tool compares cost per click instead.



The example report: 24 keywords, 30 days, a Spanish romance ebook (invented numbers).



Every verdict comes with its reason, in the writer's words: "64 clicks · 1 sale · USD 38.40 spent. You need 1 sale every 6 clicks to break even. This keyword is clearly below that."

That's the screenshot a writer posts in a Facebook group: "this free tool found USD 142 a month I was wasting."

7 Real or luck? The truth in 5 seconds

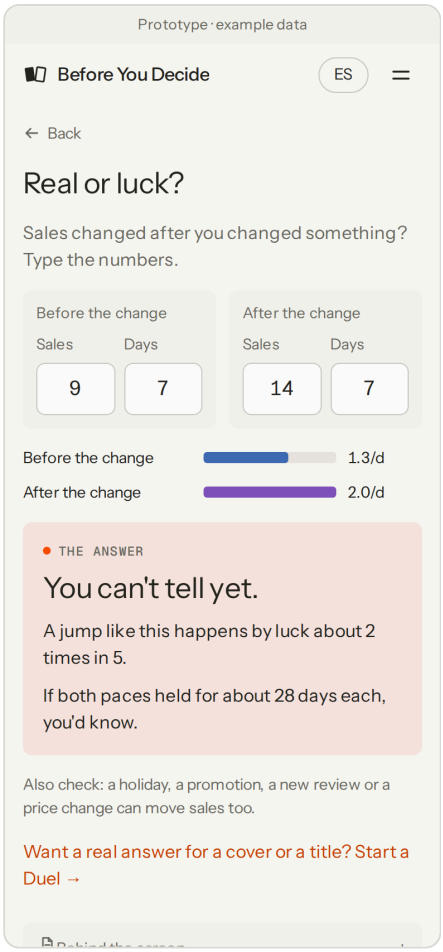
"9 sales last week, 14 this week, after my new blurb. Did it work?" It's the most-asked question in writer groups.

The answer: "You can't tell yet. A jump like this happens by luck about 2 times in 5. If both paces held for about 28 days each, you'd know."

With 9 → 30 sales the answer flips: "It's real. A change this big happens by luck less than 1 time in 1,000."

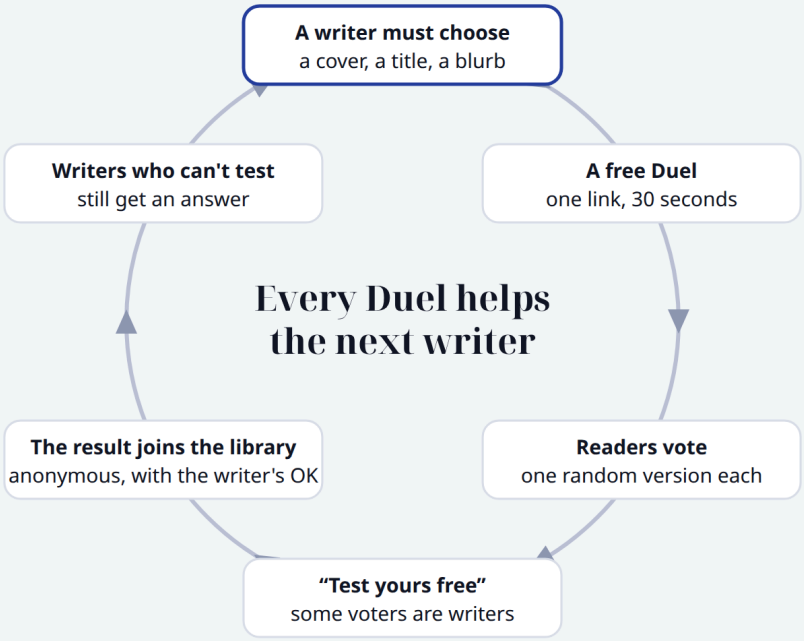
Inside: an exact test on the two sales counts, adjusted for the number of days. It also says: "a holiday, a promotion, a new review or a price change can move sales too".

Why it's a lifesaver: it stops writers from rebuilding everything around a lucky week, or dropping a good change after an unlucky one. And it points to the Duel when the change was a cover or a title.

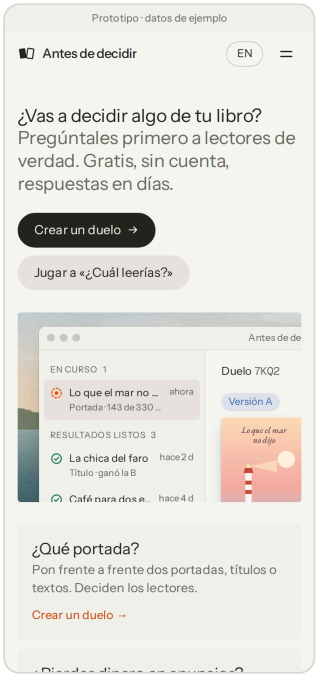


The prototype, with the example numbers.

8 How it reaches tons of people



- **The library finally fills.** Duels are free and fast, so results pile up, for example "covers with a face won 6 of 9 romance Duels" (example). That's the magic you asked for in v2.2, without waiting for ad tests.
- **Every voter is a door.** Each Duel page says "Do you write? Test yours free".
- **Wattpad:** Spanish is its second-largest language (Wattpad's president). Its writers pick covers and titles all the time, and they have readers to vote.
- **Later, optional:** the same Duel for anyone choosing between two images or texts: video thumbnails, product photos, menus, posters. Writers first; "for everyone" later.



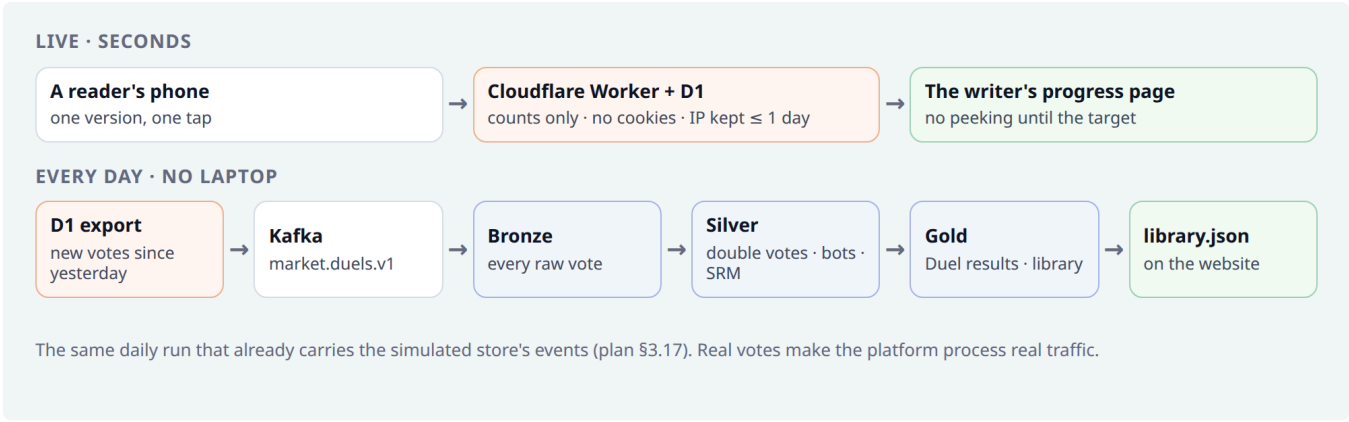
In Spanish, for writers in Latin America.



"¿Leerías la primera página?"

9 What it does for the data platform

> Real votes from real people flow through the same Kafka → Databricks pipeline. The platform stops being only a simulation.

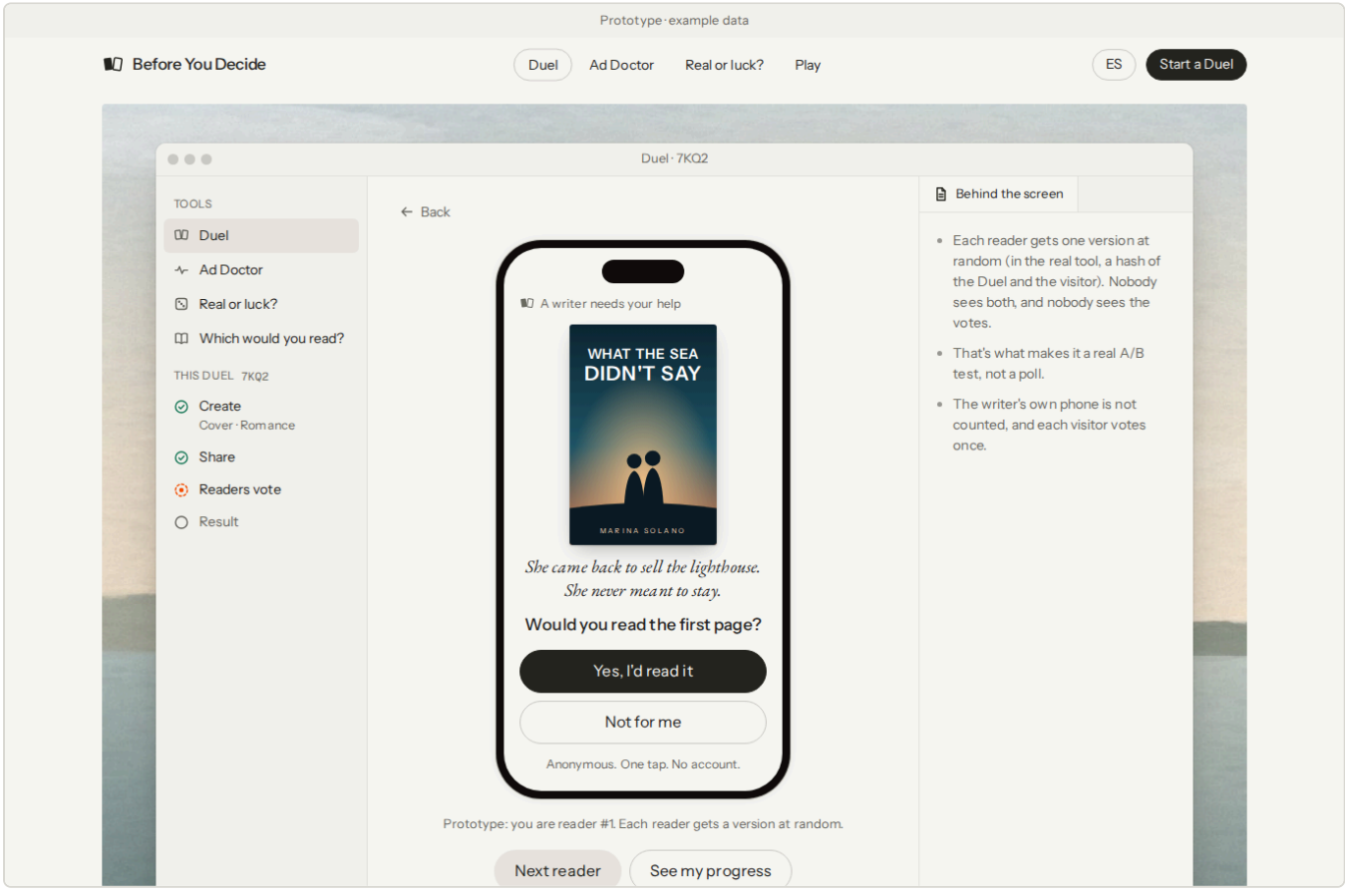


Real problems to show recruiters:

- a randomization check (SRM) on every Duel;
- double votes and bots filtered in Silver;
- no-peeking rules, written before the test;
- a library built from many real tests;
- 2 new Gold views (18 → 20): Duel results and the Duel library.

What stays: the simulated store, for recruiters only, under "Behind the scenes". It still checks the math against a known truth.

Behind the screen: the prototype shows, beside every screen, what happens underneath.



The prototype on a wide screen: the reader's view, and "Behind the screen" on the right.

10 Honest costs and risks

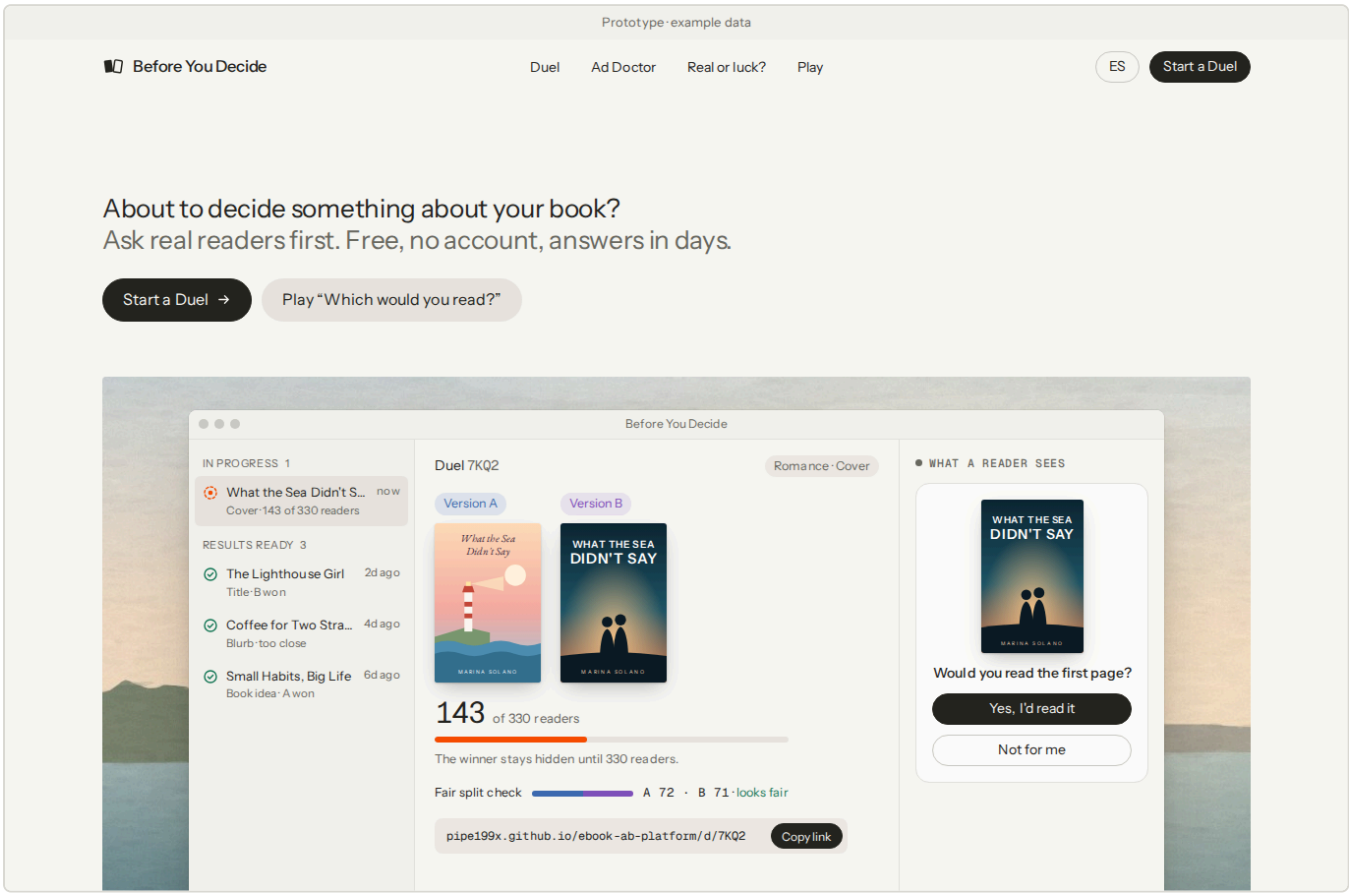
Topic	What it means
Effort	All recommended changes add about **74–110 h**. The plan goes from about 154 h to about **228–264 h**, about 11–13 weeks at 20 h a week. The "Lifesaver launch" package alone: about **36–52 h**.
$0 still holds (checked 2026-10-16)	Cloudflare Workers Free: 100,000 requests a day. D1 Free: 500 MB per database, 10 databases, 2 MB per row, 100,000 rows written a day. Covers are shrunk in the browser before upload (the prototype turned a test image into a 24 KB cover; real covers about 60 KB), so one database holds thousands of Duels. Covers are deleted 30 days after the Duel. Cloudflare R2 (file storage) asks for a payment method, so we don't use it. Fix for plan v3: the plan says D1 has "5 GB"; that is per account, and each database gets 500 MB.
Privacy	Today only the opt-in Share leaves the browser (D22, D24). A Duel needs voters' anonymous votes to leave it too: counts only, no cookies, no names, the IP never kept longer than one day. Ad Doctor and Real or luck stay fully in the browser.
Moderation	People upload images. Links are unlisted; at first you approve Duels before they enter the game; a report button; automatic deletion. A few minutes a week at first.
Votes are not sales	A Duel shows what grabs readers' attention. We say so on the result page.
Cheating	A writer voting for their favorite only fools themselves. Still: one vote per visitor per Duel, the writer's phone not counted, and the SRM check.
Cold start	Smaller, but real. The first Duels depend on the writer's own followers; the game helps writers without any.
Ad report formats	Amazon's columns and number formats vary by country and language. The prototype already reads English and Spanish files (commas or semicolons). Founding writers' sample reports make it robust.

What already exists, and what it lacks

Option	Cost	Fair test?	What it lacks
Facebook or Instagram poll	Free	**No**	Both covers side by side, visible votes, mostly friends.
Rate Book Cover (stars from strangers)	Free, paid extras	**No**	Star ratings of one cover, not two versions; voters aren't your readers.
PickFu	About $1 per answer (about $50 for 50 people), plus about $0.40 per answer for each audience filter	Panel	Paid per poll; English-first panel.
A/B test in Meta or BookBub ads	Ad money	**Yes**	Costs money and a week, and needs ad skills.
Duel	**Free**	**Yes**	Needs voters: the writer's followers plus the game.

11 The new look, in the style of cursor.com

You asked for cursor.com's style. The prototype now uses it: warm paper colors, regular-weight type, pill buttons, app windows on paintings, and a light/dark switch. We copy the style, never their name, logo, fonts or images.



The home page on a wide screen. On a phone (section 2) the same window is cropped, as on cursor.com.

Taken from cursor.com (the style):

- their color system: warm off-white paper, near-black ink, soft card grays, one orange for actions;
- type at one regular weight, tight letter spacing, and two-tone headlines (dark, then gray);
- pill buttons, flat cards with small corners, small uppercase labels, mono text for "machine" notes;
- product shown inside desktop windows on top of paintings; a sidebar with sections, as in their app;
- a footer with a system/light/dark switch, and a phone menu with big links.

Ours (nothing copied):

- the name, the logo (two book covers) and every word;
- free fonts: Instrument Sans, EB Garamond (book text), Geist Mono, embedded in the page, so it works offline;
- the paintings: seascapes with a lighthouse, drawn in code when the page opens, no image files;
- colors with a meaning: blue = version A, violet = version B, green / red / orange = verdicts;
- "Behind the screen" as a document tab next to each tool.

Change L11 on the next page brings this look to the real site and to the plan's mockups.

✓ Changes for you to pick (L1–L11)

#	Change	My advice	Effort
L1	**Duel**: cover, title, blurb or book idea. One link, one version per person, progress without peeking, the reveal and a share image. Optional first page and the writer's own "tell me when it's out" link.	Yes, the main one	25–35 h
L2	**Which would you read?** A game: readers vote, and writers earn votes by voting. You approve entries at first.	Yes	8–12 h
L3	**Ad Doctor**: Amazon and Meta reports, read in the browser. Stop / keep / luck / wait N clicks, and the money to stop wasting.	Yes	18–26 h
L4	**Real or luck?**: two numbers, an honest answer.	Yes	3–5 h
L5	**New home page with three doors**, one per pain. The library and the ad-test planner move inside.	Yes	3–5 h
L6	**The library fills itself from Duels**: opt-in, same 5-result minimum, by genre × book language × what changed.	Yes	4–6 h
L7	**Real events through the platform**: Duel events → Kafka → Bronze/Silver/Gold, an SRM check per Duel, a bot filter, 2 new Gold views (18 → 20).	Yes	8–12 h
L8	**Lifesaver first**: ship L1 + L4 + L5 right after Phase 0 (around week 3), then build the pipeline while real data arrives.	Yes (your call)	+2–4 h
L9	**A warmer voice**: plain, kind, direct sentences on every screen.	Yes	included
L10	**Later: "for everyone"**. The same Duel for any creator or small seller.	Not now	0 h now
L11	**New look in the style of cursor.com** (section 11): warm paper colors, regular-weight type, pill buttons, app windows on paintings, light and dark themes. Our own name, logo and paintings; free fonts. For the site, the mockups and the prototype.	Yes (you asked)	3–5 h

Lifesaver launch: L1 + L4 + L5 + L8 + L9 + L11, about **36–52 h**. Real writers use it around week 3.

Full: L1–L9 and L11, about **74–110 h**. Plan total about 228–264 h.

> **My advice:** before we build anything, show the prototype to 5 writers. If nobody asks "when can I use it?", we change it first.
>
> **What to reply:** for example "Lifesaver launch", "Full", or a list such as "L1, L3, L4, L8". Then I write plan v3.0, update the demo, render, and stop for your review. Nothing gets built until you say "start Phase 0".

Sources (checked 2026-10-16)

- PickFu pricing: PickFu pricing explained · How much will my poll cost
- Photofeeler karma: Using Photofeeler for free
- Amazon Ads for KDP books (US, Mexico, Spain and more): KDP help · search-term report columns: Vappingo guide
- When to pause a keyword (2–3 clicks to 30+): AdBadger · Vappingo: mistakes · Vappingo: weekly coach
- Meta Ads export (vendor guide): adsuploader
- Cloudflare: D1 pricing · D1 limits · Workers pricing · Turnstile plans · R2 needs a payment method (third-party, re-check at phase start): eastondev
- Free cover ratings today: Nicholas Rossis on Rate Book Cover · cover tests with paid ads: BookBub Insights
- Wattpad: "Spanish is the second largest language on the platform" (Jenny Lam, Wattpad president, undated interview): Prensario